

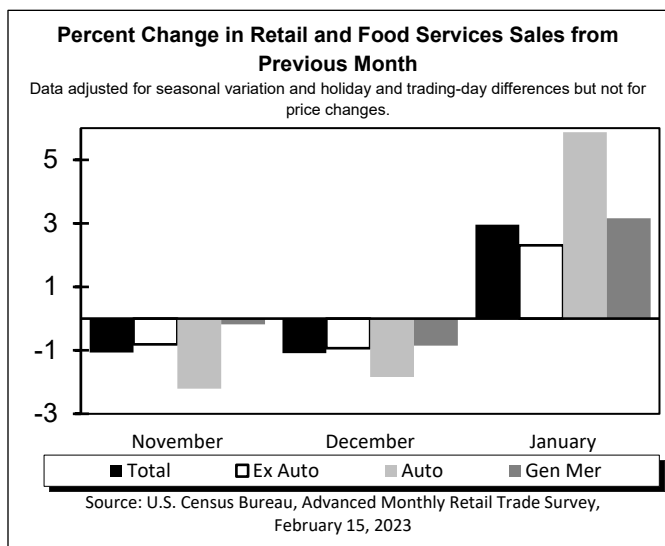
ADVANCE MONTHLY SALES FOR RETAIL AND FOOD SERVICES, JANUARY 2023

Release Number: CB23-20

Intention to Revise: Monthly retail sales estimates will be revised based on the results of the 2021 Annual Retail Trade Survey and the Service Annual Survey. Revised not adjusted estimates and corresponding adjusted estimates are scheduled for release on April 24, 2023 at 10:00 a.m. EDT.

February 15, 2023 — The U.S. Census Bureau announced the following advance estimates of U.S. retail and food services sales for January 2023:

ADVANCE MONTHLY SALES		
January 2023	\$697.0 billion	3.0%
December 2022 (revised)	\$676.9 billion	-1.1%
Next release: March 15, 2023		
* The 90 percent confidence interval includes zero. There is insufficient statistical evidence to conclude that the actual change is different from zero. Data adjusted for seasonal variation and holiday and trading-day differences but not for price changes. Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Advanced Monthly Retail Trade Survey, February 15, 2023		



Advance Estimates of U.S. Retail and Food Services

Advance estimates of U.S. retail and food services sales for January 2023, adjusted for seasonal variation and holiday and trading-day differences, but not for price changes, were \$697.0 billion, up 3.0 percent (± 0.5 percent) from the previous month, and up 6.4 percent (± 0.7 percent) above January 2022. Total sales for the November 2022 through January 2023 period were up 6.1 percent (± 0.5 percent) from the same period a year ago. The November 2022 to December 2022 percent change was unrevised at down 1.1 percent (± 0.3 percent).

Retail trade sales were up 2.3 percent (± 0.5 percent) from December 2022, and up 3.9 percent (± 0.5 percent) above last year. Food services and drinking places were up 25.2 percent (± 2.6 percent) from January 2022, while general merchandise stores were up 4.5 percent (± 0.2 percent) from last year.

General Information

The February 2023 Advance Monthly Retail report is scheduled for release on March 15, 2023 at 8:30 a.m.

Data Inquiries

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EDT. View the full schedule in the Economic Briefing Room: <<https://www.census.gov/economic-indicators/>>. The full text and tables of this release can be found at <www.census.gov/retail/>.

EXPLANATORY NOTES

The advance estimates are based on a subsample of the Census Bureau's full retail and food services sample. A stratified random sampling method is used to select approximately 4,800 retail and food services firms whose sales are then weighted and benchmarked to represent the complete universe of over three million retail and food services firms. For more information on how data is collected for the Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, see our methodology page at: <https://www.census.gov/retail/marts/how_surveys_are_collected.html>.

Survey Description

The U.S. Census Bureau conducts the Advance Monthly Retail Trade and Food Services Survey to provide an early estimate of monthly sales by kind of business for retail and food service firms located in the United States. Each month, questionnaires are mailed to a probability sample of approximately 4,800 employer firms selected from the larger Monthly Retail Trade Survey. Advance sales estimates are computed using a link relative estimator. For each detailed industry, we compute a ratio of current-to-previous month weighted sales using data from units for which we have obtained usable responses for both the current and previous month. For each detailed industry, the advance total sales estimates for the current month is computed by multiplying this ratio by the preliminary sales estimate for the previous month (derived from the larger MRTS) at the appropriate industry level. Total estimates for broader industries are computed as the sum of the detailed industry estimates. The link relative estimate is used because imputation is not performed for most nonrespondents in MARTS. For a limited number of nonresponding companies that have influential effects on the estimates, sales may be estimated based on historical performance of that company. The monthly estimates are benchmarked to the annual survey estimates from the Annual Retail Trade Survey once available. The estimates are adjusted for seasonal variation and holiday and trading day differences. Additional information on MARTS and MRTS can be found on the Census Bureau website at: <www.census.gov/retail/>.

Reliability of Estimates

Because the estimates presented in this report are based on a sample survey, they contain sampling error and nonsampling error.

Sampling error is the difference between the estimate and the result that would be obtained from a complete enumeration of the sampling frame conducted under the same survey conditions. This error occurs because only a subset of the entire sampling frame is measured in a sample survey. Standard errors

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and coefficients of variation (CV), as given in Table 3 of this report, are estimated measures of sampling variation.

The margin of sampling error, as used on page 1, gives a range about the estimate which is a 90 percent confidence interval. If, for example, the percent change estimate is +1.2 percent and its estimated standard error is 0.9 percent, then the margin of sampling error is $\pm 1.753 \times 0.9$ percent or ± 1.6 percent, and the 90 percent confidence interval is -0.4 percent to +2.8 percent. If the interval contains 0, then one does not have sufficient evidence to conclude at the 90 percent confidence level that the change is different from zero and therefore the change is not statistically significant. Estimated changes shown in the text are statistically significant unless otherwise noted. For a monthly total, the median estimated coefficient of variation is given. The resulting confidence interval is the estimated value $\pm 1.753 \times CV \times$ (the estimated monthly total). The Census Bureau recommends that individuals using estimates in this report incorporate this information into their analyses, as sampling error could affect the conclusions drawn from the estimates.

Nonsampling error encompasses all other factors that contribute to the total error of a sample survey estimate. This type of error can occur because of nonresponse, insufficient coverage of the universe of retail businesses, mistakes in the recording and coding of data, and other errors of collection, response, coverage, or processing. Although nonsampling error is not measured directly, the Census Bureau employs quality control procedures throughout the process to minimize this type of error.

Statement Regarding COVID-19 Impact

The Census Bureau continues to monitor response and data quality and has determined that estimates in this release meet publication standards. For more information, see [COVID-19 FAQs](#).

Weather Information

For information on the impact of weather events on the compilation of this report, please see the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) on our website at:

[<www.census.gov/retail/marts_weather_faqs.html>](http://www.census.gov/retail/marts_weather_faqs.html)

RESOURCES

The Rest of the Consumer Spending Story

Retail and services together represent what's commonly referred to as consumer spending. Quarterly Services Survey (QSS) revenue comprises roughly 2/3 of the personal consumption expenditures component of the U.S. Gross Domestic Product (GDP) measured by the Bureau of Economic Analysis (BEA).

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The third quarter 2022 Quarterly Services Report was released on December 8, 2022 at 10:00 AM. Learn about historical revenue trends for certain industries going back 15 years and other data, such as in-patient days and discharges for hospitals, by visiting <<https://www.census.gov/services/index.html>>.

API

The Census Bureau's application programming interface lets developers create custom apps to reach new users and makes key demographic, socio-economic and housing statistics more accessible than ever before. <www.census.gov/developers/>

FRED Mobile App



Receive the latest updates on the nation's key economic indicators by downloading the FRED App <<https://fred.stlouisfed.org/fred-mobile/>> for both Apple and Android devices. FRED, the signature database of the Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis, now incorporates the Census Bureau's 13 economic indicators.

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* The 90 percent confidence interval includes zero. There is insufficient statistical evidence to conclude that the actual change is different from zero.

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Table 1. Estimated Monthly Sales for Retail and Food Services, by Kind of Business

(Total sales estimates are shown in millions of dollars and are based on data from the Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, Monthly Retail Trade Survey, and administrative records.)

NAICS ¹ code	Kind of Business	Not Adjusted							Adjusted ²				
		1 Month Total		2023	2022			2021	2023	2022			2021
		2023	% Chg. 2022	Jan. ³ (a)	Dec. (p)	Nov. (r)	Jan.	Dec.	Jan. ³ (a)	Dec. (p)	Nov. (r)	Jan. (r)	Dec. (r)
	Retail & food services,												
	total	627,311	6.7	627,311	748,243	693,689	587,961	711,673	696,982	676,925	684,411	655,154	639,273
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts) ...	510,551	7.6	510,551	625,580	576,287	474,414	589,369	565,459	552,696	557,858	527,211	516,221
	Total (excl. gasoline stations)	575,710	6.8	575,710	694,040	634,575	538,863	659,844	637,397	617,361	621,857	598,784	582,443
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts & gasoline stations)	458,950	7.9	458,950	571,377	517,173	425,316	537,540	505,874	493,132	495,304	470,841	459,391
	Retail	540,735	4.4	540,735	657,682	609,862	518,146	632,849	601,529	587,878	595,328	578,937	560,841
	GAFO⁴	(*)	(*)	(*)	168,062	138,845	105,279	163,597	(*)	126,049	126,873	124,136	122,937
441	Motor vehicle & parts dealers	116,760	2.8	116,760	122,663	117,402	113,547	122,304	131,523	124,229	126,553	127,943	123,052
4411, 4412	Auto & other motor veh. dealers .	106,987	2.4	106,987	112,546	107,017	104,500	112,739	120,889	113,568	115,945	117,946	113,078
44111	New car dealers	(*)	(*)	(*)	95,023	88,587	84,442	92,521	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)
4413	Auto parts, acc. & tire stores.....	(*)	(*)	(*)	10,117	10,385	9,047	9,565	(*)	10,661	10,608	9,997	9,974
442	Furniture & home furn. stores	10,892	4.5	10,892	12,592	12,631	10,423	12,678	12,252	11,735	11,927	11,804	11,674
4421	Furniture stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	6,623	6,821	5,549	6,455	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)
4422	Home furnishings stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)
443	Electronics & appliance stores	6,284	-6.5	6,284	9,118	7,946	6,718	10,446	6,936	6,699	6,774	7,399	7,575
444	Building material & garden eq. & supplies dealers.....	34,904	3.4	34,904	38,763	40,441	33,771	38,294	42,675	42,541	42,074	42,229	41,347
4441	Building mat. & sup. dealers	(*)	(*)	(*)	33,417	35,367	29,770	33,323	(*)	36,884	36,386	37,073	36,103
445	Food & beverage stores.....	78,947	5.3	78,947	88,686	82,147	74,984	82,729	81,311	81,248	81,348	76,585	76,057
4451	Grocery stores	72,040	5.8	72,040	77,546	73,388	68,099	71,845	72,989	72,950	72,950	68,441	67,906
4453	Beer, wine & liquor stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	8,018	6,269	4,939	7,701	(*)	6,024	6,069	5,852	5,839
446	Health & personal care stores	33,793	4.9	33,793	37,423	33,665	32,224	37,356	33,997	33,354	33,971	32,815	32,855
44611	Pharmacies & drug stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	29,513	27,503	27,297	30,120	(*)	27,151	27,837	27,434	27,283
447	Gasoline stations	51,601	5.1	51,601	54,203	59,114	49,098	51,829	59,585	59,564	62,554	56,370	56,830
448	Clothing & clothing accessories stores	19,301	6.6	19,301	40,629	29,072	18,113	39,375	26,739	26,082	26,248	25,158	25,316
44811	Men's clothing stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(*)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(S)
44812	Women's clothing stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	4,470	3,807	2,422	4,340	(*)	3,410	3,399	3,318	3,326
44814	Family clothing stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	16,137	12,348	6,734	14,606	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)
4482	Shoe stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	4,577	3,498	2,218	4,557	(*)	3,343	3,446	3,320	3,373
451	Sporting goods, hobby, musical instrument, & book stores	7,769	6.9	7,769	13,437	10,277	7,270	12,824	9,406	9,383	9,368	8,801	8,999
452	General merchandise stores.....	62,946	3.4	62,946	88,869	76,493	60,884	85,128	71,602	69,410	70,003	68,530	66,890
4521	Department stores	9,071	3.1	9,071	16,972	12,726	8,799	17,073	11,978	10,192	10,899	11,368	10,242
4529	Other general merch. stores.....	(*)	(*)	(*)	71,897	63,767	52,085	68,055	(*)	59,218	59,104	57,162	56,648
45291	Warehouse clubs & supercenters.....	(*)	(*)	(*)	61,072	54,396	45,340	57,754	(*)	50,640	50,507	49,016	48,492
45299	All oth. gen. merch. stores.....	(*)	(*)	(*)	10,825	9,371	6,745	10,301	(*)	8,578	8,597	8,146	8,156
453	Miscellaneous store retailers	13,261	6.1	13,261	16,287	14,909	12,496	15,595	15,722	15,295	15,072	14,740	14,611
454	Nonstore retailers	104,277	5.7	104,277	135,012	125,765	98,618	124,291	109,781	108,338	109,436	106,563	95,635
4541	Elect. shopping & m/o houses	(*)	(*)	(*)	122,574	114,374	87,596	113,929	(*)	97,358	98,513	96,684	86,704
722	Food services & drinking places	86,576	24.0	86,576	90,561	83,827	69,815	78,824	95,453	89,047	89,083	76,217	78,432

(*) Advance estimates are not available for this kind of business.

(NA) Not available (a) Advance estimate (p) Preliminary estimate (r) Revised estimate

(S) Estimate does not meet publication standards because of high sampling variability (coefficient of variation is greater than 30%), poor response quality (total quantity response rate is less than 50%), or other concerns about the estimate's quality.

(1) For a full description of the NAICS codes used in this table, see <<https://www.census.gov/naics/>>.

(2) Estimates are concurrently adjusted for seasonal variation and for holiday and trading day differences, but not for price changes. Concurrent seasonal adjustment uses all available unadjusted estimates as input to the X-13ARIMA-SEATS program. The factors derived from the program are used in calculating all seasonally adjusted estimates shown in this table. Year-to-date seasonally adjusted sales estimates are not tabulated. Adjustment factors and explanatory material can be found on the Internet at <<http://www.census.gov/retail/>>.

(3) Advance estimates are based on early reports obtained from a small sample of firms selected from the larger Monthly Retail Trade Survey (MRTS) sample. All other estimates are from the MRTS sample.

(4) GAFO represents firms which specialize in department store types of merchandise and is comprised of furniture & home furnishings (442), electronics & appliances (443), clothing & accessories (448), sporting goods, hobby, musical instrument, and book (451), general merchandise (452), office supply, stationery, and gift stores (4532).

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, February 15, 2023. Table 3 provides estimated measures of sampling variability. Additional information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, sample design, and definitions may be found at <www.census.gov/retail/how_surveys_are_collected.html>.

Table 2. Estimated Change in Monthly Sales for Retail and Food Services, by Kind of Business

(Estimates are shown as percents and are based on data from the Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, Monthly Retail Trade Survey, and administrative records.)

NAICS code	Kind of Business	Percent Change ¹					
		Jan. 2023 Advance from --		Dec. 2022 Preliminary from --		Nov. 2022 through Jan. 2023 from --	
		Dec. 2022 (p)	Jan. 2022 (r)	Nov. 2022 (r)	Dec. 2021 (r)	Aug. 2022 through Oct. 2022	Nov. 2021 through Jan. 2022
441 4411, 4412 442 443 444 445 4451 446 447 448 451 452 4521 453 454 722	Retail & food services, total	3.0	6.4	-1.1	5.9	-0.2	6.1
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts)	2.3	7.3	-0.9	7.1	-0.1	7.1
	Total (excl. gasoline stations)	3.2	6.4	-0.7	6.0	0.2	5.9
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts & gasoline stations)	2.6	7.4	-0.4	7.3	0.4	7.0
	Retail	2.3	3.9	-1.3	4.8	-0.7	4.6
	Motor vehicle & parts dealers	5.9	2.8	-1.8	1.0	-0.7	1.8
	Auto & other motor veh. dealers ...	6.4	2.5	-2.1	0.4	-0.8	1.3
	Furniture & home furn. stores	4.4	3.8	-1.6	0.5	-0.2	1.2
	Electronics & appliance stores	3.5	-6.3	-1.1	-11.6	-6.7	-8.8
	Building material & garden eq. & supplies dealers.....	0.3	1.1	1.1	2.9	-2.0	2.1
	Food & beverage stores.....	0.1	6.2	-0.1	6.8	1.5	6.9
	Grocery stores	0.1	6.6	0.0	7.4	1.7	7.5
	Health & personal care stores	1.9	3.6	-1.8	1.5	-0.1	3.1
	Gasoline stations	0.0	5.7	-4.8	4.8	-3.8	8.1
	Clothing & clothing accessories stores	2.5	6.3	-0.6	3.0	0.3	3.2
	Sporting goods, hobby, musical instrument, & book stores	0.2	6.9	0.2	4.3	0.6	4.1
	General merchandise stores.....	3.2	4.5	-0.8	3.8	0.5	3.7
	Department stores	17.5	5.4	-6.5	-0.5	-3.3	0.7
	Miscellaneous store retailers	2.8	6.7	1.5	4.7	-3.5	4.9
	Nonstore retailers	1.3	3.0	-1.0	13.3	-0.6	8.1
	Food services & drinking places	7.2	25.2	0.0	13.5	3.3	17.1

(p) Preliminary estimate (r) Revised estimate

(1) Estimates shown in this table are derived from adjusted estimates provided in Table 1 of this report.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, February 15, 2023. Table 3 provides estimated measures of sampling variability.

Additional information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, sample design, and definitions may be found at

<www.census.gov/retail/how_surveys_are_collected.html>.

Table 3. Estimated Measures of Sampling Variability and Revision to Advance Estimates Jan. 2023

(Estimates are shown as percents and are based on data from the Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey and Monthly Retail Trade Survey)

NAICS Code	Kind of Business	Median CV ⁽¹⁾ for Current Mo. (%)	Median standard error ⁽¹⁾ for Percent change			Revision for month-to-month change ⁽²⁾	
			Previous Mo. to Current Mo.	Previous Qtr. to Current Qtr.	Current Mo. to same Mo. Last Yr.	Average revision	Median absolute revision
441 4411, 4412 442 443 444 445 4451 446 447 448 451 452 4521 453 454 722	Retail & food services,						
	total	0.8	0.3	0.2	0.4	0.1	0.2
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts)	0.9	0.2	0.2	0.4	0.1	0.2
	Total (excl. gasoline stations)	0.9	0.3	0.2	0.4	0.1	0.3
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts & gasoline stations)	1.0	0.3	0.2	0.4	0.2	0.3
	Retail, total	0.7	0.3	0.2	0.3	0.1	0.2
	Motor vehicle & parts dealers	1.6	0.9	0.4	1.1	0.0	0.4
	Auto & other motor veh. dealers	1.6	1.0	0.4	1.1	0.0	0.4
	Furniture & home furn. stores.....	2.7	1.0	0.7	1.6	0.4	0.9
	Electronics & appliance stores	2.1	0.6	0.5	0.9	0.2	0.6
	Building material & garden eq. & supplies dealers.....	2.6	0.7	0.5	1.1	0.0	0.4
	Food & beverage stores.....	0.7	0.1	0.2	0.4	0.1	0.2
	Grocery stores	0.7	0.1	0.2	0.5	0.1	0.1
	Health & personal care stores	3.3	0.4	0.3	0.9	0.3	0.6
	Gasoline stations	1.3	0.5	0.3	0.9	0.0	1.2
	Clothing & clothing accessories stores	2.6	0.9	0.7	1.4	0.0	0.4
	Sporting goods, hobby, musical instrument, & book stores	2.7	0.9	0.9	1.6	0.0	0.2
	General merchandise stores.....	1.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.1
	Department stores	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.1
	Miscellaneous store retailers	5.2	2.8	1.3	3.2	-0.6	2.3
	Nonstore retailers	1.6	0.5	0.4	0.6	0.3	0.8
	Food services & drinking places	3.7	0.9	0.6	1.5	0.4	0.7

(1) Estimated measures of sampling variability are based on estimates not adjusted for seasonal variation or holiday or trading day variation. Medians are based on estimates for the most recent 12 months.

(2) These columns provide measures of the difference between the advance-to-preliminary and preliminary-to-final estimates of month-to-month change for the same pair of months as measured by the Advance sample and MRTS sample. The average and median revisions are based on estimates for the most recent 12 months.

 Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, February 15, 2023. Additional information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, sample design, and definitions may be found at <www.census.gov/retail/how_surveys_are_collected.html>.